

Essential Medicines List

The World Health Organization (WHO) maintains a Model List of Essential Medicines, which includes drugs considered critical for addressing the most important public health needs. Examples include abacavir for HIV/AIDS, amoxicillin for bacterial infections, metformin for diabetes, and paracetamol for pain relief. These medicines are selected based on their efficacy, safety, and cost-effectiveness. National essential medicines lists are adapted to local disease patterns and healthcare infrastructure. Ensuring access to essential medicines is a key goal of universal health coverage and is monitored as part of global health indicators.